

## CAREER PATHS

Sales executives need to be ambitious and determined because career progress depends entirely on hitting sales targets. Successful salespeople are typically promoted to handle larger and more valuable clients, and may go on to join a company's management team. Sales skills are highly transferable, and it is not unusual for sales executives to move between different industries.

**SALES ASSISTANT** You may begin your career in an administrative role, supporting senior salespeople. Your employer is likely to teach you about the company's products and sales techniques before you start to deal with customers.

**SALES EXECUTIVE** Sales executives represent an organization's products or services, and build and manage relationships with customers. With experience they can move into several other fields of work.

### KEY ACCOUNT MANAGER

Takes on responsibility for dealing with their employer's most valuable clients or product areas.

**SALES MANAGER** Coordinates a company's sales operations in a region or country, setting targets and advising staff on ways to improve their performance.

## SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills for presenting product information to potential customers.



Good interpersonal skills to handle queries and complaints in a professional manner.



Strong organizational skills and self-motivation in planning and making sales calls and visits.



A sound knowledge of business practices, and an awareness of customer expectations.



Good numerical skills for calculating percentages, discounts, and profits on sales.

### SPECIALIZED SALES EXECUTIVE

Works in the financial sector, selling products such as mortgages and investments, or in other fields, selling products, such as pharmaceuticals or Information Technology (IT) systems.

### MARKETING EXECUTIVE

Researches customer needs and behavior and plans a company's strategy to promote its products.

